

These action items can lead to outcomes like:

- Cloud transformation strategies and roadmap
- Confidence in cloud services capabilities
- Business needs amalgamation for a solution on the cloud
- Alignment with all stakeholders
- Educated employees for cloud services management and maintenance
- Cloud expert team
- Best practices in place
- Transformed people, processes and platforms
- Well established security, compliance and governance processes
- No dependency on single cloud providers
- High level of security and compliance establishment
- Well defined processes, policies and practices for cloud execution
- Highest degree of customer satisfaction

Cloud computing service models

It is important to understand the available cloud computing service models while migrating to the cloud. There are three cloud computing models — PaaS, IaaS, and SaaS (Figure 1).

PaaS: This cloud computing model facilitates the entire environment, which includes storage, servers, networking, OS, etc. Users can have their applications and data built on these platforms. Some of the examples for PaaS are *Force.com*, *Google App Engine*, and *Commerce Tools*.

IaaS: This provides an automated and scalable environment with flexibility and control over the system. Some of the examples for IaaS are *Amazon Web Services (AWS)*, *Rackspace*, *Google Cloud Engine*, *Microsoft Azure*, *Flexiscale*, etc.

SaaS: These are the applications available over the Internet.

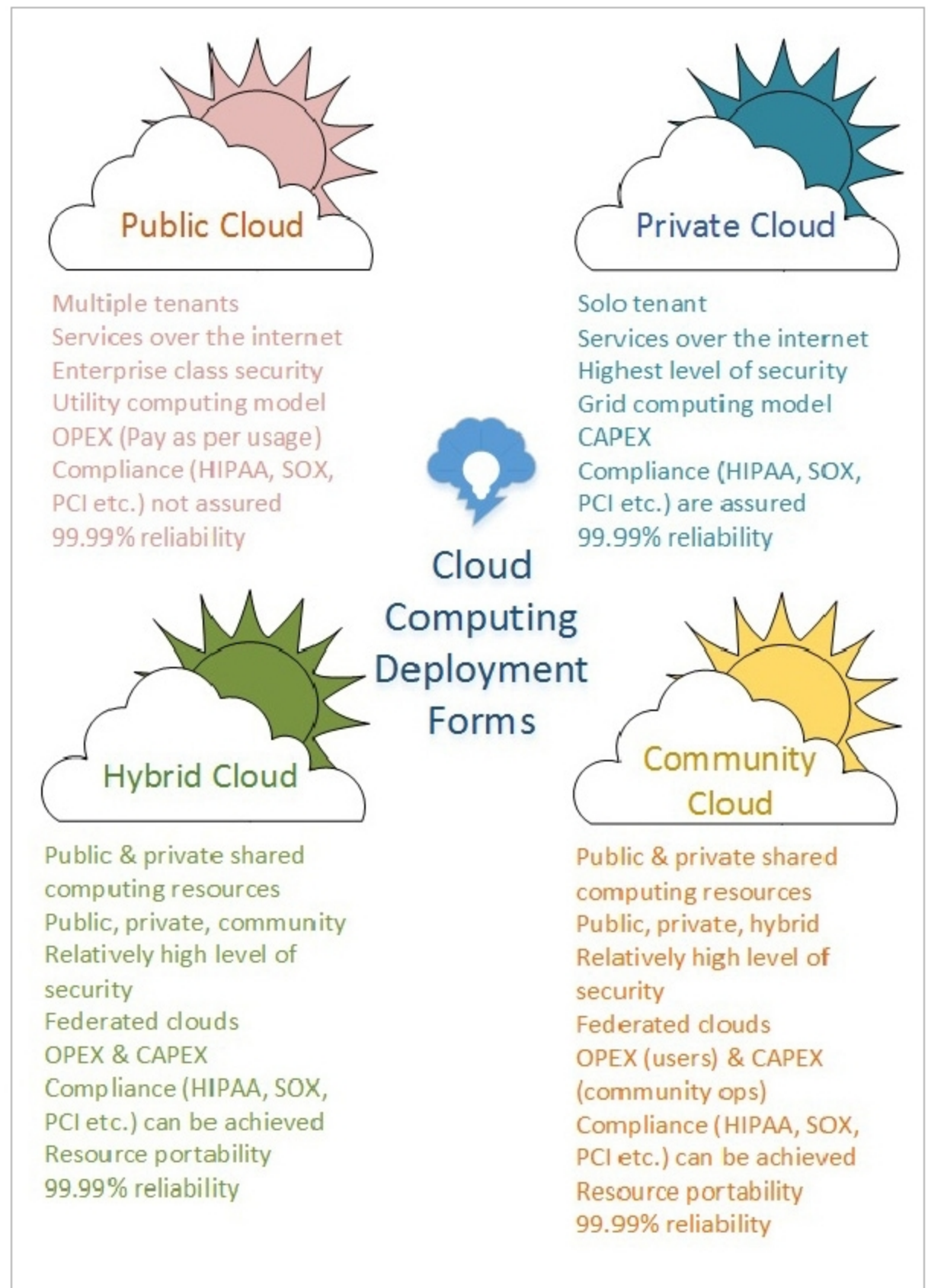


Figure 2: Cloud computing models

Users have less control over the customisation or tailoring of features. Some of the examples are *Gmail*, *Google Doc*, *Citrix GoToMeeting*, *Cisco WebEx*, etc.

Additionally, there are many other X-as-a-Service available like DaaS (Data-as-a-Service), SoaaS (Storage-as-a-Service), SeaaS (Security-as-a-Service), etc. Enterprise cloud solutions are generally a combination of all these service models.

Cloud deployment models

There are some input parameters for identifying the right cloud computing deployment forms like security needs, data management needs, and type of data. The different forms of cloud computing are shown in Figure 2.

Public cloud: These cloud services are for generic usages, and are hard to customise as per the organisation's need. They work on a pay-per-use basis, and are available over the Internet for